Report/Case Study

Enhancing Professional Growth Through Effective Communication and Listening Skills

Strategies for Professional Growth Sept' 2025

Project Title: Enhancing Professional Growth through Communication and Listening Skills

Team 9

Roll Number	Student Name	Interviewed Professional
23f3001764	Sahil Raj	Kajal Sharma (Teacher)
22f3002275	B D Jahnavi	Chandana Tom (BI Analyst)
22f2001175	Lakshika Sheoran	Kanishka (CTO)
22f2000776	Sailaja Nallamothula	Sai Charan Kruthiventi (AI Analyst)
23f1001232	Sahil Sharma	Anshu Sharma (PT Teacher)

Methodology – Our Study Approach

Investigation Steps

TEAM-9 started off checking the SPG course rules to zero in on boosting work skills using clear talking and active listening. For firsthand info, we each did outside interviews while gathering background material from existing sources. After that, we jumped on a group video chat to piece everything together. Instead of polls, group talks, or trials, we stuck to conversational insights - this kept things more about understanding than counting.

Primary Data Collection (Interviews)

One out of every five people did a short chat - around 15 to 20 minutes - with someone employed; each conversation followed loose prompts but stayed focused on work life

- Sahil Raj (23f3001764): Kajal Sharma - a teacher with over three years of experience - collected 17 tales from real classrooms, focusing on how flexible speaking styles match up with sharp listening skills.
- B D Jahnavi (22f3002275): Chandana Tom, BI Analyst with around a year and a half in the role - shares thoughts about how teams understand each other, along with fixing mix-ups when they happen.
- Lakshika Sheoran (22f2001175): Kanishka, serving as CTO for four years - she focuses on how team members communicate, really listen while others speak, then share useful responses within technical groups.
- Sailaja Nallamothula (22f2000776): Sai Charan Kruthiventi - an AI analyst having over a year's experience - talks through roadblocks such as confusing terms while also exploring ways to adjust and move forward.
- Sahil Sharma (23f1001232): Anshu Sharma, works as a PT instructor with two years of experience - focuses on clearing up confusion while helping groups get along better.

Interviews included hands-on questions, taped after spoken approval - strictly for school work - then typed up and gathered inside TEAM_9_SPG_IR_Sep_2025.pdf to study themes

Secondary Sources

Team members gathered supporting materials via **Google Scholar, TED.com, and YouTube** to validate primary insights (no direct copying):

- **TED Talks/Videos**: John Igwebuike, Scott Pierce, Julian Treasure (TED); Matt Abrahams; Patrick Winston (MIT)
- **Movies/Sitcoms**: *The Big Bang Theory*, *Young Sheldon*, *Thank You for Smoking* (2005)
- **Books**: Dale Carnegie; Cheryl Hamilton; Bryan A. Garner (HBR); Kitty Locker & Stephen Kaczmarek; John C. Maxwell; Michael P. Nichols
- **Journals/Articles**: Debra Schifrin; Douglas Squirrel & Jeffrey Fredrick; *International Journal of Business and Social Science*; Daminova Gulabza Ismatovna

These were reviewed via web searches (Google Scholar, TED.com) to validate primary insights without direct copying.

Analysis & Recommendations

Analysis

The below are the insights drawn collectively from all the interviewees:

1. **Clear Communication**: Across every interview, one insight was consistent: clarity saves time. When instructions are vague or incomplete, people interpret them differently, which leads to confusion and unnecessary reworks. Communicating clearly of what needs to be done, by whom, and by when makes work smoother and helps avoid reworks and clarifications.
2. **Handling Misunderstandings**: Miscomunication happens everywhere (in discussions, workplace etc.), sorting it out by direct conversation resolves conflicts faster. This approach cleared doubts quickly and maintains professional relationships.
3. **Respectful Feedback**: All professionals highlighted the importance of giving feedback. Instead of pointing out mistakes harshly, suggesting improvements in a polite manner encourages growth, improves team performance and relationships and makes the positive and healthier environment. In workplace settings, feedback helps individuals improve without conflict.
4. **Active Listening**: Listening isn't just about hearing but actively engaging, taking notes, clarifying questions, asking doubts and confirming the key understandings. This reduced misunderstandings and prevented rework, especially when working with diverse departments or teams. It helped interviewees/ or working professionals avoid reworks and meet expectations accurately.
5. **Documentation**: Interviewees highlighted the importance of documenting key points, follow-ups or summaries. Having written clarity prevents confusion later and ensures that everyone is on the same page/aligned. Documentation also becomes a reference when taking or decisions needs to be revisited.

Conclusion: Based on the experiences and insights of professionals, across diverse industries and roles, one common finding is observed: Effective communication and Active Listening are not just soft skills, they directly influence on productivity, workplace relationships and professional growth.

Actionable Recommendations

1. **Start every meeting with a clear purpose**
   When starting with any meeting or a group discussion start it with a like a one line clear goal for example, "Today's goal is to finalize the client proposal" or "We're here to assign responsibilities for next week's tasks.".This helps to create clear understanding between team members and focus on their task assigned.
2. **End with a short written summary and clear ownership**
   With end of any meeting the habit of summarizing the key takeaways in points like
   i. What was decided
   ii. your task
   iii. deadline and other requirements
   improves coordination and avoid any miscommunication and misunderstanding from beginning.
3. **Encourage active listening through confirmation**
   The habit of paraphrasing after the meeting or discussion to confirm the understanding of both parties is

quite necessary to prevent any misunderstanding and also shows your engagement in the discussion.

4. **Practice communication through short weekly sessions**
   Communication improves with practice and just theory. Spending time for small activities like paraphrasing drills,summarizing a meeting or discussion and also by observing other. Polish our skill to interact better with our peers.
5. **Create a "listening culture" from day one**
   With formation of a new team start by asking everyone to write their expectations or working preferences.Engage in open discussion for better understanding among team members which set a tone of mutual respect in early stages.
6. **Document decisions, not just discussions**
   Instead of lengthy notes keep only the records of essential points useful for future refers.

Conclusion

With use of these actionable steps, teams can to reduce their miscommunication, rework, and conflict. These are low input but high impact skills that can be taken inhabit by any group . Over time, these habits will help foster trust, efficiency, and continuous learning an environment which is truly the hallmark of good communication and effective teamwork.

Influence Model: Communication and Listening Skills in Professional Growth

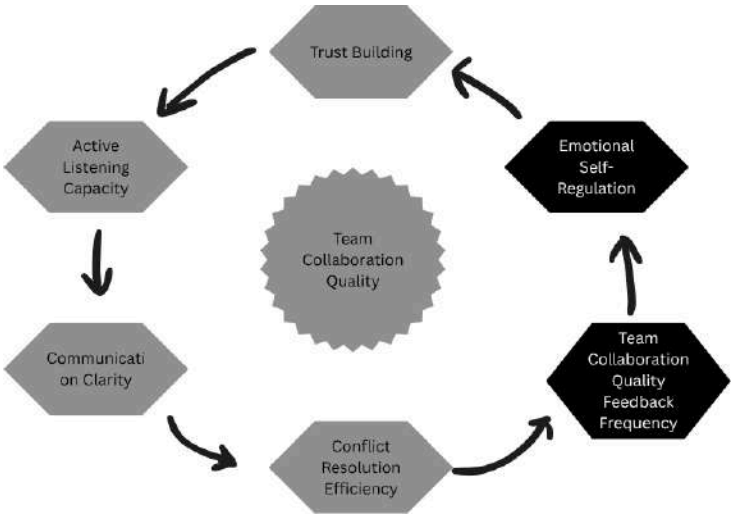
- **Key Variables**

Active Listening Capacity	Deep attention to others' viewpoints to ensure mutual understanding.
Communication Clarity	Clear, jargon-free, and audience-adapted expression of ideas.
Feedback Frequency	Regular, respectful feedback cycles for performance alignment.
Emotional Self-Regulation	Remaining calm and composed under stress or conflict

- **Intervening Variables**

Trust Building	Strengthens interpersonal confidence and openness.
Conflict Resolution Efficiency	Reduces misunderstandings through calm clarification.
Team Collaboration Quality	Collective performance and shared ownership.

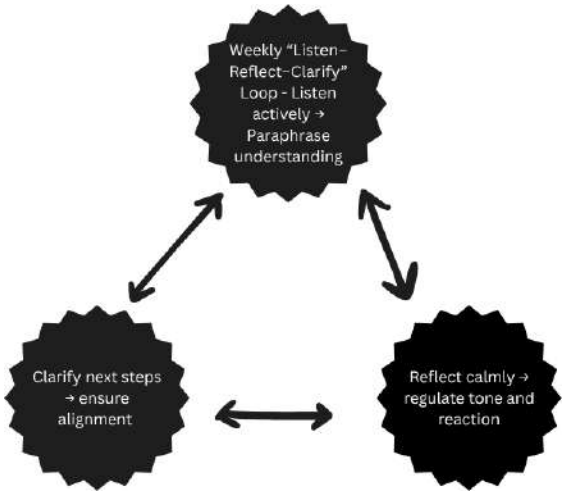
- **Influence Flow**



- **Real-World Context: Insights from Group Interviews**

Kanishka (CTO, Klapclub)	Active listening reduced miscommunication; faster delivery & fewer project errors.
Chandana (Analyst, Kofluence)	Direct clarification solved conflicts faster; better alignment across departments.
Sai Charan (Deloitte)	Adapted communication for multicultural teams; improved clarity and client satisfaction.
Anshu (Teacher)	Calm tone and clarity built student trust and engagement.
Kajal (Facilitator)	Paraphrasing and reflection built respect and collaboration.

- **Implementation Snapshot**



Result: Higher trust, fewer conflicts, measurable team collaboration improvement

- **Key Takeaway**

  Teams practicing listening-led communication demonstrated tangible gains in collaboration, clarity, and trust proves that emotional self-regulation and structured feedback directly drive professional growth

Project Review & Closure

Team 9 has five members named Sahil Raj, Lakshika Sheoran, B D Jahnavi, Sailaja, Sahil Sharma. The Project theme is on “Enhancing the professional Growth through Effective Communication and Listening Skills”, where it’s not just about speaking its about listening, understanding and building the good relationship between team members and their respective team managers. Sahil Raj (23f3001764) served as a ‘Project Coordinator’ of the team where he make sure of video editing, accountability of deadlines, template designing and project management plan. Lakshika Sheoran (22f2001175) served as a ‘Team Lead’ where she make sure smooth coordination for GP1, GP2 work, also keeping meetings for the team discussing, collaborations with members for GA, also helped with interview questions and project closure. Sailaja (22f2000776) served as a ‘Research Head’ of the team where she collected all the secondary resources required for our project such as video clips, TED talks, also helped with influence model and team contract. B D Jahnavi (22f3002275) served as ‘Creative head’ of the team where she helped with template designing of GP2 final report, team contract, project, swot analysis and drafted analysis of the interviewees insights. Sahil Sharma (23f1001232) served as a ‘Communication Head’ of the team where he took care of communicating with members regarding the guidelines and clearing the miscommunications, he also helped in giving recommendations regarding on our project theme.

The Project provided insights on practical applications of Communication and listening skills also with interview helping in finding practical ways through which fresher can strengthen these skills to get succeed not just in career but in life too. We extend our sincere appreciation for professional workers who shared their time and contributing to the depth of our findings. The Project has been a collaborative effort, we express gratitude to all members for successful completion of project.